



MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING for the establishment of the

*Alliance for Artificial Intelligence
in Higher Education
SMARTIE*

Founding institutions

Accreditation Council for Entrepreneurial and Engaged Universities

FH OO Forschungs & Entwicklungs GmbH

Politecnico di Bari

Universitatea Babeș Bolyai din Cluj-Napoca

Universitatea din Craiova

Universidade de Lisboa

Univerza v Ljubljani

Universidad de Malaga

Žilinská Univerzita v Žiline

Establishment of

Alliance for Artificial Intelligence in Higher Education - SMARTIE

Memorandum of Understanding

Between

1. *Accreditation Council for Entrepreneurial and Engaged Universities*, address: Wilhelm-Schickard-Str. 14, 48149 Muenster, Germany, represented by Chair, Thorsten Kliewe
2. *FH OÖ Forschungs & Entwicklungs GmbH*, address: Roseggerstraße 15, 4600 Wels/Austria, represented by Rector, Gerald Reisinger
3. *Politecnico di Bari*, address: Via Edoardo Orabona, 4, 70126 Bari BA, Italia, represented by Rector, Francesco Cupertino
4. *Universitatea Babeş-Bolyai din Cluj-Napoca*, address: Strada Mihail Kogălniceanu 1, Cluj-Napoca 400347, Romania, represented by Rector, Daniel David
5. *Universitatea din Craiova*, address: 13 A. I. Cuza Street, 200585, Craiova, Romania, represented by Rector Cezar Ionuț Spînu
6. *Universidade de Lisboa*, address: Alameda da Universidade, 1649-004 Lisboa, Portugal, represented by Rector Luís Manuel dos Anjos Ferreira
7. *Univerza v Ljubljani*, address: Kongresni trg 12, 1000 Ljubljana, Slovenia, represented by Rector Gregor Majdič
8. *Universidad de Málaga*, address: Avda. Cervantes, 2. 29071 Málaga, Spain, represented by Rector Jose Angel Narvaez-Bueno
9. *Žilinská Univerzita v Žiline*, address: Univerzitná 8215/1, 010 26 Žilina, Slovakia, represented by Rector Ján Čelko

which will be further referred to as the ***Parties***.

Preamble

The Parties, recognizing the importance of international academic cooperation, as well as the need to raise awareness about the integration of Artificial Intelligence (henceforth: AI) in higher education, conclude the current Memorandum of Understanding (henceforth: MoU) to promote the close cooperation and academic exchange in the context of the project **Synergistic Management and Advancement of Artificial intelligence in European Higher Education (SMARTIE)**.

The parties are founding members of the SMARTIE network. Parties may also invite other academic, institutional, and civil society entities to become members of the SMARTIE network.

The establishment of the SMARTIE Network is based on the project *"Synergistic Management and Advancement of Artificial intelligence in European Higher Education"* nr. 2024-1-RO01-KA220-HED-000244949, co-financed by the European Commission through the ERASMUS+ program. Its existence and activities start during the implementation of the project, and they continue after the ending of the project, in the conditions defined by the present MoU.

Article 1

1. The purpose of this MOU is to memorialize the Parties' intent to develop academic and educational cooperation, and to promote relations and mutual understanding between the Parties, in the fields of the SMARTIE Network: Artificial Intelligence and Innovation.
2. Each of the Parties undertakes to explore ways in which they might promote and develop academic cooperation within fields that are mutually acceptable and directly linked to the general and specific purposes of the SMARTIE Network.
3. The main activities of the SMARTIE Network will be related to the research, education, and communication regarding the fields of Artificial Intelligence and Innovation.

4. This Memorandum of Understanding is not intended to be a legally binding agreement. It confers no rights, imposes no obligations and creates no liability on the part of either party. Nothing herein shall diminish the full autonomy of either Institution in the conduct of its activities with respect to this Memorandum of Understanding.

Article 2

In accordance with the current regulations of each state and within the defined boundaries determined by mutual consent, in order to reinforce the role of the SMARTIE Network in advancing knowledge, fostering innovation, and shaping the future of AI in higher education, each of the Parties might consider the realization of activities that revolve around, but are not limited to, those mentioned below:

1. Academic Exchange Programs, by:

- a. Facilitating the exchange of faculty, research staff, and students (undergraduate and graduate) between partner institutions.
- b. Promoting the development of academic partnerships that encourage long-term collaboration.
- c. Organizing summer schools and faculty-led programs to encourage cross-institutional learning.
- d. Inviting guest lecturers to deliver talks and conduct specialized seminars.
- e. Promoting internships and training mobility opportunities for students and researchers.

2. Joint Research and Knowledge Sharing, by:

- a. Developing collaborative research projects in fields of mutual interest, with an emphasis on AI.
- b. Organizing joint conferences, workshops, and/or seminars to exchange ideas and advance academic discourse.
- c. Participating in conferences, workshops, and/or seminars with papers and/or presentations and/or posters co-authored by members of the Parties.

- d. Supporting the co-authorship of scientific publications and participation in grant programs.
- e. Disseminating best practices in teaching and research, particularly in AI and related disciplines.

3. Capacity Building and Professional Development, by:

- a. Providing mutual assistance to enhance the scientific and teaching skills of faculty and researchers.
- b. Promoting academic exchanges to develop innovative teaching methodologies.
- c. Offering support for the implementation of new educational programs, particularly related to AI.

4. Strengthening the SMARTIE Network, by:

- a. Inviting new institutional and individual members to join the SMARTIE Network.
- b. Encouraging collaboration with experts from education, technology, business, and communication to share knowledge and raise awareness about AI's impact on higher education.
- c. Promoting dialogue and fostering the shared cultural and organizational values of the SMARTIE Network.

5. Supporting Mobility and Institutional Cooperation, by:

- a. Facilitating student exchanges, subject to the admission criteria of the receiving institution.
- b. Promoting the development of structured academic partnerships that encourage long-term collaboration.
- c. Enhancing institutional cooperation to create a sustainable and dynamic academic environment.

Article 3

In order to materialize the above-mentioned activities, each of the Parties involved will develop the details for each type of cooperation, as well as the obligations that each of the Parties involved must fulfil regarding administrative procedures, timelines, and other logistical aspects, ensuring the long-term sustainability of the collaboration.

Article 4

The terms and conditions of any projects, programs, or other activities that the Parties wish to implement in furtherance of the purposes of this MoU shall be subject to negotiation and formal written agreement by the Parties. Moreover, the terms and conditions of any agreement for such projects, programs, or other activities will be subject to approval by legal representatives of each of the Parties involved.

Article 5

Each Party hereto shall respect and, to the extent applicable, abide by the laws and regulations as well as the cultural, religious and social customs of the other party, to the extent that such laws and regulations, and cultural, religious and social customs would not cause either party to violate its own laws and regulations or its own obligations under this MoU.

Article 6

1. This Statement of Shared Interest shall be valid from the date it is signed by all Parties for a period of five (5) years, unless there is an agreement to be terminated earlier. Either party may terminate this MoU by providing thirty (30) days' written notice to the other Parties.
2. If one of the Parties wishes to leave the SMARTIE Network, it shall notify all of the other Parties of this intention, providing thirty (30) days' written notice. Leaving the SMARTIE Network will have no legal implications.

3. If one of the Parties has notified that it intends to leave the SMARTIE Network, but there are contractual obligations between this Party and other Parties (student mobility, teacher mobility, implementation of projects financed by various programs, etc.), the exit from the SMARTIE network will be recorded, but ongoing activities will be completed according to existing contracts.
4. This Agreement is drawn up and signed in nine copies in English, all texts being equally authentic. Each party stores a copy of the MoU.
5. The parties, by their duly authorized representatives, hereby execute this MoU on the dates set forth below.
6. The English version of this Memorandum of Understanding will govern the interpretation of its language.
7. Contacts for this Statement of Shared Interest will be as follows:

Appendix 1. Accreditation Council for Entrepreneurial and Engaged Universities

Appendix 2. FH OO Forschungs & Entwicklungs GmbH

Appendix 3. Politecnico di Bari

Appendix 4. Universitatea Babeş Bolyai din Cluj-Napoca

Appendix 5. Universitatea din Craiova

Appendix 6. Universidade de Lisboa

Appendix 7. Univerza v Ljubljani

Appendix 8. Universidad de Málaga

Appendix 9. Žilinská Univerzita v Žiline

Appendix 1. *Accreditation Council for Entrepreneurial and Engaged Universities*

Legal Representative

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Liaison Person

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Appendix 2. *FH OO Forschungs & Entwicklungs GmbH*

Legal Representative

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Liaison Person

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